

Stats: 640 stores, 35 000 staff, 15 000 new hires each year, average age 17, average time with company 2 years

Minimum hours per week: ‘At least two shifts a week, though we are flexible’.

How to apply: Go to careers.kfc.com.au/apply/

Rob Phipps is one of the top roosters at KFC. He’s actually been with the company for 28 years, having started when he was still in high school. That explains why, when it comes to hiring kids, he approaches it with Colonel Sanders-like wisdom:

‘Look, it’s their first job. We don’t expect people to know how to “bread” a chicken. And we also understand that we’re the kids’ fifth priority: there’s family, school, sport, friends—and we’re okay with that.’

What should kids wear to the interview?

‘They can turn up in school uniform. Preferably with their shoes polished, hair clean, and mobile phone switched off and out of sight.’

Can you give me an inside hack on getting a job at KFC?

‘I personally think there is something in fronting up to the store between 2 pm and 4 pm and asking to speak with the manager. There’s something strong about saying, “Hey, here I am, here’s my résumé, this is my availability.”’

Do you have any tips on acing the interview?

‘Don’t try and pretend. Be okay about not having worked before. I’m a father to a teenager so I get it!’

How long will it take from submitting my application to dunking nuggets in the deep-fryer?

‘For us, speed is key—no more than two weeks from application to getting the job.’